

Kunj Patel

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GitHub: <https://github.com/kunj127> | Portfolio: <https://kunj127.github.io/>

EDUCATION

The Pennsylvania State University

Master of Business Administration (MBA)

State College, PA

Aug. 2025 – May 2026

The Pennsylvania State University

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

State College, PA

Aug. 2021 – May 2025

- Minors: Cybersecurity, Mathematics
- GPA: 3.59/4.00

EXPERIENCE

Lead Software Engineer – Impact Incubator

May 2025 – Present

Impact Incubator

State College, PA

- Led a team of **3 developers** building a **cross-platform React Native mobile app (iOS/Android)** used by **1,000 students** and scaling to **18,000+ students**, collaborating closely with designers and stakeholders.
- Architected and maintained a **Node.js backend on AWS EC2 with MongoDB**, implementing **RESTful APIs**, authentication, and scalable data storage.
- Built an internal **Next.js analytics dashboard** to visualize product and user engagement metrics, enabling data-driven decision-making for the team.
- Collaborated with a funded **AI startup** to explore **AI-driven features**, demonstrating applied awareness of **Generative AI capabilities**.

Lead Software Engineer – THON

April 2024 – Present

THON™, the world's largest student-run philanthropy

State College, PA

- Served as **Project Manager** for **THON**, supporting fundraising platforms responsible for **\$254M+** raised for pediatric cancer research and coordinating **16,000+ student volunteers**.
- Led **end-to-end full-stack development** of **store.thon.org**, a production **e-commerce platform** serving thousands of users and generating **\$30K/month** in revenue.
- Built the frontend with **Nuxt.js (Vue)** and **TypeScript** and backend with **Django**, using **MySQL** for data persistence and designing **RESTful APIs** for product catalog, order management, transaction processing, and internal service integrations.
- Implemented secure payment workflows via **Evalon payment processing**, ensuring **PCI DSS compliance** through tokenization, encryption, and least-privilege access control.
- Integrated the platform with **multiple internal services** for inventory management, order fulfillment, and reporting, maintaining data consistency across THON systems.
- Deployed production infrastructure using **AWS ECS, Docker, CloudFormation, S3, and CloudFront**, enabling scalable, repeatable **CI/CD** deployments.
- Managed **CI/CD pipelines** and collaborated through **GitHub pull requests** in an **Agile/Scrum** development environment.
- Monitored and optimized system performance using **OpenTelemetry** and **AWS X-Ray**, while **leading and mentoring 3 developers** across engineering and design teams.

Solutions Engineer Intern

June 2024 – August 2024

Samtek Inc.

Aldie, VA

- Developed **AWS Lambda** functions to analyze and display cloud usage costs, working within **Scaled Agile** development practices.
- Troubleshoot and analyzed data pipelines involving **Lambda, S3, Glue, Athena, and QuickSight**, supporting backend data validation and visualization workflows.
- Debugged serverless applications and optimized data queries to improve reporting accuracy and performance.

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified AI Practitioner – Amazon Web Services (July 2026)

SKILLS

Languages: Java, JavaScript, TypeScript, Python, C/C++, SQL, HTML/CSS, Verilog, Dart

Frameworks & Libraries: React, React Native, Next.js, Vue.js, Flutter, Django, Node.js

Cloud & DevOps: AWS (EC2, Lambda, S3, ECS, CloudFormation, CloudFront, DynamoDB, Athena, Glue, QuickSight, X-Ray), Docker, CI/CD, Git, GitHub

Databases: MongoDB, DynamoDB, PostgreSQL, MySQL

Practices: Agile/Scrum, RESTful API Design, PCI DSS Compliance, OOP, SDLC

Other Tools: Linux, Bash Scripting, Unix Terminal, MIPS Architecture